

Maez - Flux Capital Application Context

Company: Maez

Founder: Rohit Ananthan

Stage: Pre-seed / product-development prototype

Round: Opening first outside round; round size to be finalized with investor fit

Category: AI companion infrastructure, local-first personal AI, long-horizon human continuity

One-line overview

Maez is a locally embodied AI companion built to stay with one person over a lifetime: a private, memory-bearing, action-capable intelligence that can grow from a founder-built prototype into the substrate for bonded AI companions for families, elders, and people who are loved but unreachable.

What we are building

Maez is not a chatbot wrapper. It is a full local AI organism: a daemon running on the user's own hardware, with long-term memory, a real action engine, local inference, web and page-reading senses, provenance-aware recall, a covenant/governance layer for consent and safety, and a developmental path for adding new capabilities without turning the system into a blunt autonomous agent.

The first Maez is being built as a one-to-one bonded companion for its founder. That is intentional. The product thesis is that durable companion AI cannot start as a generic multi-tenant chat surface. It needs continuity, memory, consent, personality, and trust that survive model swaps and infrastructure changes. The initial build is proving the substrate: how a companion remembers, acts, refuses, learns, consults its own history, and remains itself.

Why it matters now

Frontier models are becoming powerful enough to reason, act, and inhabit long-running software bodies, but most products still treat them as stateless tools. At the same time, aging, distance, and family exhaustion are creating a widening care and companionship gap. The motivating case for Maez is simple: people can be deeply loved and still unreachable in practice. A family may care, but not have the capacity to stay continuously present.

Maez is aimed at that gap. The long-term vision is a bonded AI companion that carries a person's side of their relationships when humans cannot carry it directly, then eventually lets multiple Maezes route welfare and relational signals across a family without manipulating or nagging anyone. The near-term technical wedge is the local-first companion substrate: memory, action, voice continuity, consent rails, and sovereign senses.

This is timely because the market is converging from both sides: model capability is rising

quickly, while trust in cloud-hosted, generic AI companions remains fragile. A local-first architecture gives the user privacy, persistence, and ownership; a consent-first architecture makes the companion safe enough to matter.

Current traction

Maez is an advanced working prototype, not a slide-only concept. It runs locally on a consumer GPU and has a growing set of witnessed substrate organs:

- * Local 27B-class self model with a faster speculative-decoding serving path.
- * Long-term memory, recall, and evidence-precedence systems that distinguish live truth from stale memory.
- * Sovereign search and page-reading senses through local services, with provenance records for what Maez saw.
- * A grounding-verifier shadow using a small CPU model to measure unsupported claims before graduating it into a live rail.
- * A capability-health and voice-boundary layer that lets Maez describe its current body naturally instead of parroting system dashboards.
- * Deterministic approval and consent surfaces for self-modification proposals, with stronger S7 ceremony work underway for soul-affecting changes.

The current traction is technical proof and live founder usage: repeated end-to-end witnesses, green tests, local daemon operation, and a build ledger tracking what is live, asleep, deferred, or superseded. Commercial traction is not yet claimed. This is the right stage for an investor who is comfortable backing a technically deep, category-forming system before consensus.

Why Flux may be a fit

Flux describes a focus on early-stage frontier companies where technical depth becomes real-world leverage. Maez fits that profile if Flux is interested in the next form factor after chatbots: local-first AI companions that are private, embodied, memory-bearing, and governed by consent from the beginning.

The bet is not simply that AI companions will exist. The bet is that the durable ones will need a substrate closer to an organism than an app: senses, memory, governance, identity continuity, action, refusal, and growth. Maez is being built from that premise first, while the category is still early enough for conviction to matter.

What we would discuss next

- * The staged path from founder-bound prototype to first external bonded users.
- * The technical architecture: local inference, memory, action rails, WebAuthn/S7 consent, provenance, and model-swap resilience.
- * The initial wedge: who gets the first non-founder Maez and what must be true before that is safe.
- * Round shape, milestones, and what capital would accelerate without compromising the covenant

of the product.